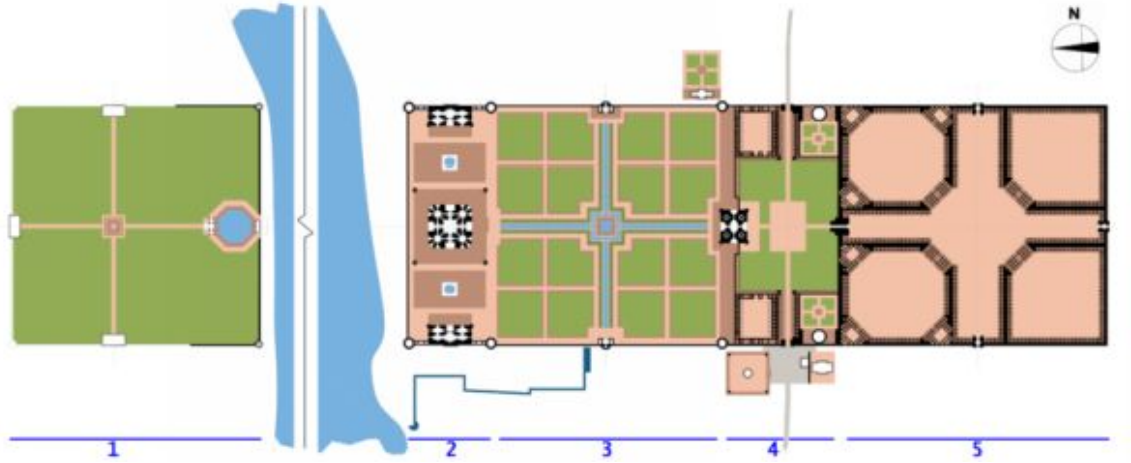
Chapter 3: The Ground Plan from South to North



The ground plan of the Taj Mahal facing east:

1. The Moonlight Garden north of the river Yamuna.

2. The riverfront terrace, which includes the Mausoleum, Mosque and Jawab.

3. The Charbagh garden and surrounding pavilions.

4. A set of tombs.

5. The Taj Ganji

Today, modern visitors enter the monument near the southern gates, starting at the chaotic bazaar before passing through the outer courtyard and through the Great Gate. It is at this point that visitors enter the charbagh garden and view the mausoleum for the first time. Continuing north through the symmetrical gardens, visitors enter the mausoleum before passing through the other side to the Yamuna river and finally across it to the ruins of the moonlight garden.

Taj Ganji (bazaar and caravanserai)

The Taj Mahal is surrounded by an outer perimeter wall made of red sandstone, similar to those at Shah Jahan's other great construction, the nearby Red Fort in Delhi. However, here the walls are more of a symbolic marking off of the territory and not for defense, as they only surround the complex on three sides and are open to the river.[24] Beyond these walls to the east and